

Statement of Teaching Philosophy

Learning in the classroom is an iterative, active process and requires adapting to each student's starting point. My goal is not only to equip students with a set of applicable models, but also to help them develop their intuition about how incentives, tradeoffs, and unintended consequences interact. I first engage students by connecting course material to their own interests and adapting to their individual learning styles. I then push them further by encouraging students to embrace productive failure and think critically about what they are learning. During my time at the University of Georgia, I have served as the instructor of record for Principles of Microeconomics, I have guest lectured in public policy and economics courses, and have been a teaching assistant for courses in economics of education, data science, macroeconomics, and economic history.

I strive to invest students in their own learning by connecting course objectives with their interests. In my Principles of Microeconomics course, students complete a final project on a policy of their choosing. They identify what type of policy it is, such as a tax, a quota, or a price ceiling, graph the standard model of that policy, and reason through the possible market outcomes and unintended consequences. Students are practicing identical analytical steps, but on topics they're genuinely interested in: I've had projects ranging from NYC congestion pricing to the pink tax. The topics students pick also tend to reflect the range of backgrounds in the room, since they gravitate toward policies that touch their own lives. Across every project, the analytical core stays constant, while the topic is what makes an abstract concept feel accessible and relevant to that student.

Students do not only enter the classroom with their own interests, but with their own learning styles. Therefore, I use a range of active learning activities to articulate ideas. Before formally introducing a new topic, I have students work through activities designed to make that concept feel concrete. For example, students might map out the competitive landscape of a market in their hometown before we discuss market structures, or crawl under their desks and try to stand up to experience a binding price ceiling. We connect these activities to the lesson for the day, and I continue to call back to them throughout class to emphasize abstract ideas. I then support the lesson with problem sets and worksheets so students have practice applying ideas and technical skills. The range of activities provides opportunities for comprehension across different learning styles. I've adapted this same approach for 300-student guest lectures on market structure. Since

the hometown-mapping activity relies on walking through individual students' examples as a class discussion, I traded it for an in-class worksheet suited to the larger format.

Furthermore, economic reasoning can be difficult, and I want that difficulty to be productive rather than discouraging. That requires both room to fail, and real stakes to make the effort matter. I grade problem sets on completion, giving students room to work through misunderstandings without penalty, but I warn them upfront that exam questions are structured like the problem sets, so homework is where they're expected to identify what they don't yet understand. I offer test corrections on my midterms, and students can earn back partial credit, contingent on a written reflection that shows they've identified their error and can walk through the correct reasoning. The cumulative final has no corrections, which keeps the stakes real and reinforces that iteration is a tool for building understanding earlier in the course, not a substitute for mastering the material by the end of it.

Finally, I encourage my students to engage in critical thinking and evaluate their own and others' beliefs. I consistently ask students to consider who wins and who loses from a given policy or market outcome, whether we're discussing taxes, tariffs, price ceilings, minimum wage, or patents. When we discuss why a government might impose tariffs even when the world price is below the domestic price, or work through the direct and indirect consequences of labor unions and where those benefits might not be worth the cost, I push students to disagree with each other, hear different opinions, and revisit their own conclusions as new arguments come up. Common phrases I use in these discussions are "Are you sure?" and "What other outcomes are possible?" to prompt students to evaluate their initial views. This kind of open disagreement is what turns a model students can recite into a conclusion they've actually stress-tested themselves.

In future classes, I aim to continue connecting economic theory to students' diverse interests and experiences, engaging my class through active, varied learning activities, and encouraging them to iterate over mistakes and think critically. The specific activities and opportunities for connection will shift depending on the course and the classroom, but the underlying goal stays the same: to give students an analytical toolkit that is curious, rigorous, and durable enough to hold up when someone pushes back on their conclusions.